

What type of family are you?

Four months is a good moment to think about what kind of parents you want to be—for example, whether you like routines or prefer to take the day as it comes. Audit the first few months of your baby's life and see what has worked well and what has been less successful. You may have different styles and approaches as parents, so it's a good idea to agree on the top priorities for your baby. Do you want her to go to sleep at the same time every evening no matter what; or will you keep her up to say goodnight if a working parent returns home late? Will you get a babysitter or be relaxed about taking her out with you if you go to friends' houses for dinner? Should she sleep in her own room all night or do you mind having her in your room? You may also need to decide whether to always have a calming story at bedtime rather than excited play, even if you have been at work all day and want to have some fun with her. Write down what's most important to you both and discuss how to achieve it.

Visit an art gallery or museum



Make the most of getting out and about to places that you enjoy visiting while your baby is still very portable: put her in a carriage or front-facing baby pack and take her to an art gallery or museum. Alternatively, you might prefer to take her to a local garden center, sports event, or market. She should enjoy taking in the new environment as long as she feels secure and close to you.